

TB Center

Version: 1.3.0 | Documentation date: 2026-08-04

Overview

Brings a scattered or unstable stereo image toward a clear center while letting you keep the width you want.

What this plug-in solves

Stereo recordings can lean unpredictably, wander as performers move, or feel unfocused because level and arrival-time differences disagree. Simple balance controls can move the image but cannot correct timing, and mono summing can remove valuable width. TB Center is intended for dialogue, stereo microphones, instruments, buses, and archival material that need a more stable center without indiscriminately collapsing the recording.

What you can expect

- A more stable dominant image
- Reduced left/right timing disagreement
- Controlled width after recentering
- Frequency-dependent correction when multiband mode is enabled

How it works

TB Center listens to how the left and right channels differ in level and arrival time. It uses those differences to identify where the shared focus of the recording is leaning, then guides that focus toward the middle without simply turning the whole signal into mono.

Intensity decides how firmly the correction is applied, Response decides how quickly it follows movement, and Time Center addresses timing smear between the channels. Width and the four band weights are the final creative controls: they let you preserve ambience or openness in selected parts of the spectrum while the important material stays centered.

Quick start

- 1 Insert the plug-in on a stereo track and begin with Init.
- 2 Set Intensity while listening for a stable center rather than maximum narrowness.
- 3 Adjust Response so movement is followed without audible image pumping.

- 4** Use Time Center only as far as needed to remove timing smear.
- 5** Set M/S Width for the final spatial size.
- 6** Enable Multiband only when different frequency regions need different correction strengths.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Intensity and Response

Intensity sets how strongly the detected offset is corrected. Response determines how quickly the detector follows movement: slower settings feel stable and natural, while faster settings track rapidly changing material.

Lookahead analysis

Lookahead gives the detector more future context and can make fast centering decisions cleaner. It adds processing latency and is best changed while playback is stopped when the host does not support dynamic latency changes smoothly.

Time Center

Time Center reduces inter-channel arrival-time differences. Use it when the image remains smeared after level centering; reduce it when the original stereo timing is an important part of the space.

M/S Width

The final mid/side stage moves from mono-compatible narrowing through the original width to deliberate widening. Recheck phase correlation and mono compatibility whenever the sound is widened.

Multiband weighting

Multiband enables independent Low, Mid-Low, Mid-High, and High correction weights. Reduce a band to preserve more of its original placement and increase it only when that area needs firmer centering.

Programs and visualization

Factory programs provide repeatable starting points for dialogue, natural centering, moving sources, bus recentering, and air-preserving width. The display is an analysis aid; make final decisions by ear and in mono.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Band High	Sets how strongly the high-frequency area is pulled toward the center. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band Low	Sets how strongly the low-frequency area is pulled toward the center. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band Mid-High	Sets how strongly the upper-mid area is pulled toward the center. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band Mid-Low	Sets how strongly the lower-mid area is pulled toward the center. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Intensity	Sets how strongly the plug-in corrects the stereo position. Start near the middle and raise it only until the image feels stable. Raise it until the contribution is obvious, then reduce it slightly and recheck the sound in the complete mix.
Lookahead	Helps the plug-in handle quick position changes more smoothly. Higher values can sound steadier but slightly less immediate. Judge this control while the source repeats in the full arrangement. The right timing should support the groove without making the sound feel detached.
M/S Width	Sets the final stereo width after centering. Its neutral position keeps the original width; lower settings narrow it and higher settings widen it. Check the result on speakers, headphones, and in mono when possible. Extreme spatial settings can feel exciting but may not translate everywhere.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Multiband	Lets the low, mid, and high areas use different centering strengths. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.
Response	Sets how quickly the center follows movement. Lower values feel smoother; higher values track moving sounds faster. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Time Center	Moves the left and right arrival timing toward the center. Raise it when the image feels smeared or pulled apart. Judge this control while the source repeats in the full arrangement. The right timing should support the groove without making the sound feel detached.

Practical uses

Moving dialogue

- Start with Natural Center or Locked Dialogue.
- Raise Response until head movement is controlled.
- Keep low-band correction firm for intelligibility.
- Reduce high-band weighting if room reflections become unnaturally fixed.

Expected result: Speech remains centered and readable while the room retains useful dimension.

Stereo bus recentering

- Start at moderate Intensity.
- Leave Time Center below maximum unless timing is visibly unstable.
- Begin with M/S Width at its neutral position, then trim only as required.
- Check mono and compare equal loudness.

Expected result: The mix gains focus without losing its intended stereo scale.

Common pitfalls

The processor cannot create missing stereo information. Reduce width or movement and check the result in mono as well as stereo. Preserve the original spatial cues when they are important to the recording.

Excessive correction can make ambience unnaturally static. Reduce width or movement and check the result in mono as well as stereo. Preserve the original spatial cues when they are important to the recording.

Widening can expose phase problems that were already present. Reduce width or movement and check the result in mono as well as stereo. Preserve the original spatial cues when they are important to the recording.